BOTSWANA EXAMINATIONS COUNCIL

STANDARD FOUR ATTAINMENT TEST

ENGLISH **October/November 2023**

Marks: 50 **Time: 80 Minutes**

SURNAME: _____ **NAME:** _____

SCHOOL: _____

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Answer all questions.
2. Read each question carefully before you answer.
3. All your answers must be written in this question paper.
4. Where you have to choose an answer, circle the letter of the correct answer like this (A).
5. Do not spend a lot of time on a question that is hard for you. Answer other questions and then get back to the hard one later.
6. When you have finished the test, go over your work to make sure there are no mistakes.

THIS QUESTION PAPER CONTAINS 9 PRINTED PAGES.

© BEC 2023 **DO NOT TURN THE PAGE UNTIL YOU ARE TOLD TO DO SO.**

For questions 1 to 4 underline the word that completes each sentence correctly.

The people in the village became very excited. Nearly half of them **1** (take, took) their bows and arrows and ran towards the cave. “That crocodile **2** (is, has been) a problem for a long time. Today we **3** (go, are going) to catch it,” the Chief shouted. When the villagers came near the cave, they **4** (saw, see) the crocodile resting in the sunshine outside the cave. (4)

Adapted from More African Folk Tales, by Hugh Vernon - Jackson.

Fill in the blank spaces with one of the following punctuation marks in order to complete each sentence correctly in questions 5 to 7.

Puntuation marks: ? . , !

5. Which team won the match ..... (1)

6. Kitso came late to school yesterday ..... (1)

7. What a beautiful jacket..... (1)

Read the passage below and use it to answer questions 8 to 13.

A farmer and his seeds

As soon as the rains came, a man went out to his lands to start ploughing. He worked hard to get his field ready before he sowed his seeds. But some parts of it had a lot of stones and thorn trees. He could not get rid of all the stones and thorns.

Another challenge was that right through the middle of the field, cattle had made a path on their way to drink water. When he started sowing, the seeds fell in different areas. The seeds that fell on the path were eaten by birds. The seeds that fell among the stones began to grow, but there was not enough soil and water so the young plants died. The seeds that fell among the thorns began to grow too, but the thorns crowded **them** out and they died.

Some of the seeds got into the good soil and they grew very well. The farmer got one hundred times as much maize as the seeds he sowed.

Adapted from The Storyteller, A Moso Publication.

8. When did the farmer start ploughing?

A Before the rain fell
B Sometime after the rain fell
C Immediately when the rain fell (1)

9. What problem did the farmer have when preparing to plough?

A He could not remove the stones and thorns from the field.
B He did not have enough tools to clear the field.
C He did not have enough soil in his field. (1)

10. What had made the path that was in the middle of the field?

A Wild animals
B Cattle
C Birds (1)

11. What does the proun "**them**" in paragraph 2 refer to?

A Thorns
B Seeds
C Stones (1)

12. Why did the young plants that grew among the stones die?

A They could not get enough air.
B They were dried up by the heat of the sun.
C The soil and water were not enough to keep them growing. (1)

13. The statement that says, "**The farmer got one hundred times as much maize as the seeds he sowed**" means that the farmer

A got more maize from ploughing. (1)
B used a lot of seeds.
C was a hard worker.

In questions 14 to 17 underline the word that completes each sentence correctly in the following paragraph.

Mrs Tabo asked the pupils to play a bus service game. "I am the driver," said Jack. "I will be **14** (his, her) conductor," said Mary. **15** "(Me, I) too," said Thato. "No," Mrs Tsheko said. "We do not need two conductors. Lillian and the rest of us will be passengers. Jack will drive **16** (ours, us) to town. **17** (He, She) will have to drive carefully because it is raining.

(4)

The following sentences make a story. Arrange them in the correct order by writing 2, 3 and 4 in the blank spaces. The first one has been done for you.

Example: ….1…. The thieves broke into her house.

18. …… Then she phoned the police. (1)

19. …… First, she locked herself up in the bedroom. (1)

20. …… Finally, the police came. (1)

Complete the sentences in questions 21 to 32 by underlining the correct word from the ones given in brackets.

21. (This, That) cat over there is mine. (1)

22. (A, An) elephant eats leaves and grass. (1)

23. There is (a little, a few) jam in the bottle. (1)

24. How (much, many) sugar do you need in your tea? (1)

25. (A lot of, Much) people go to church every Sunday. (1)

26. Tiro is the (more handsome, most handsome) boy in class. (1)

27. A buffalo is not as (stronger, strong) as a lion. (1)

28. Tlotlo is (better, good) at Mathematics than Thato. (1)

29. A cheetah is the (fastest, fast) animal in the world. (1)

30. (Who, What) is your name? (1)

31. (Where, What) are you going? (1)

32. She is hungry (so, but) she does not want to eat. (1)

Change sentences in questions 33 and 34 into questions.

Example

Sentence: I am writing a book.

Question: Am I writing a book?

33. **Sentence:** She is going to the cattlepost.

Question:…….…….. (1)

34. **Sentence:** Katlego is singing to her friends.

Question:……..…….. (1)

Arrange the words in questions 35 to 37 in alphabetical order.

35. [Touch, Catch, Fetch]

…….…….. (1)

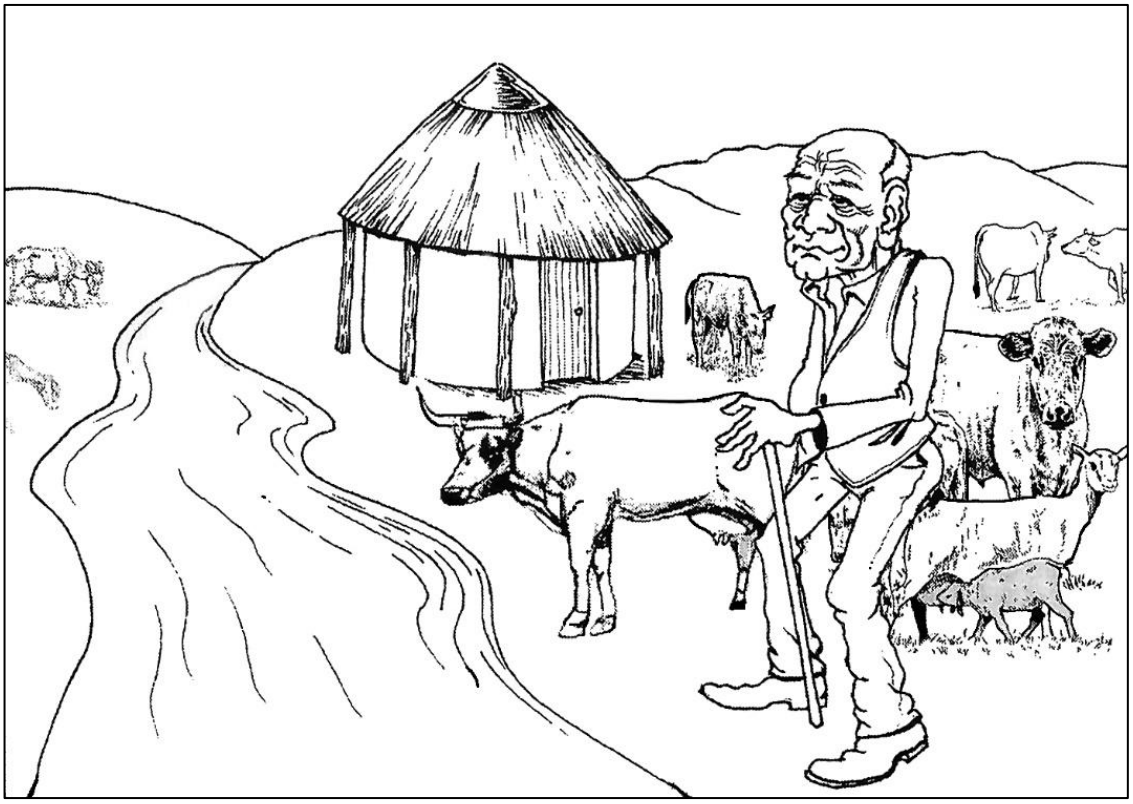
36. [Kick, Injure, Bite]

…….…….. (1)

37. [Charge, Change, Cheap]

…….…….. (1)

Use the picture below to answer question 38.



38. Describe **three** things that are shown in the picture.

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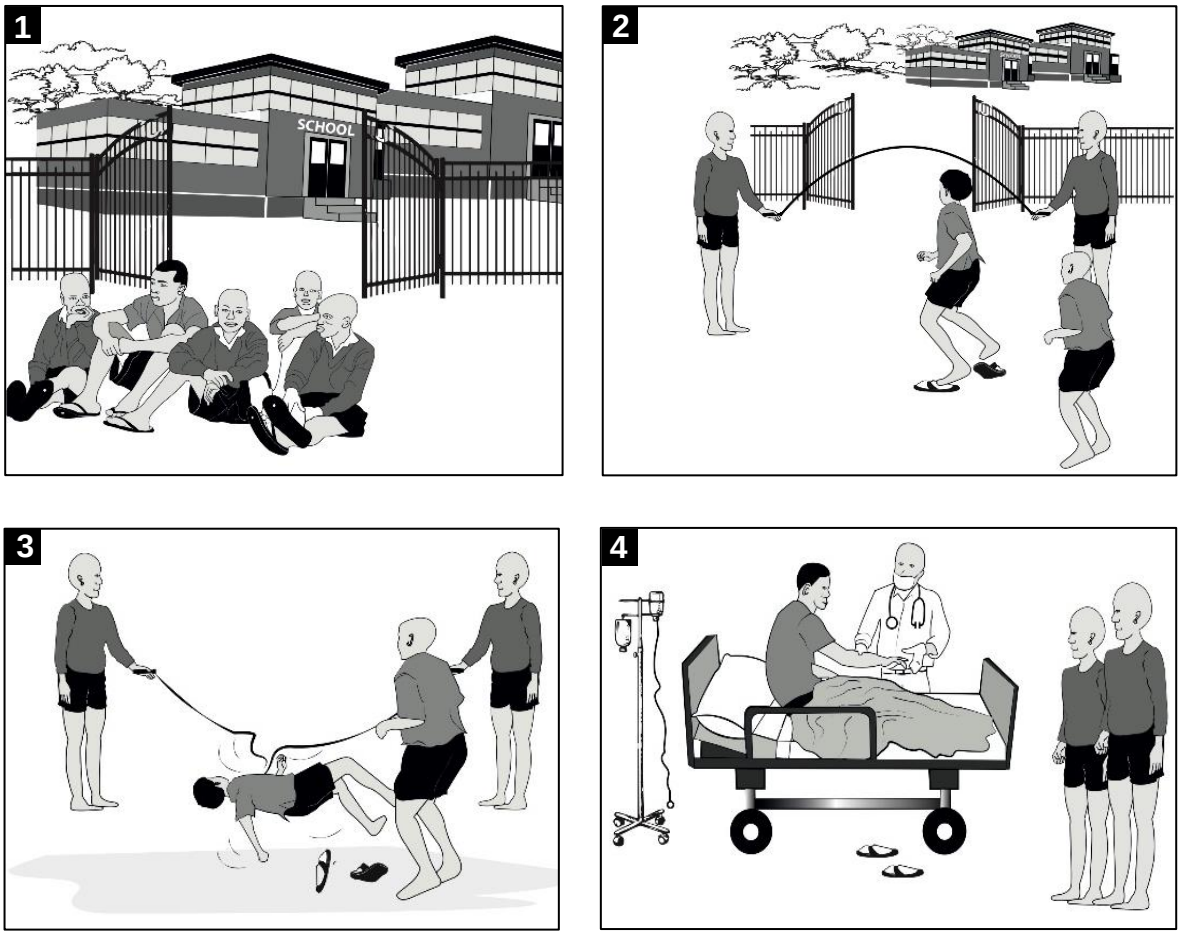
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..... (3)

Use the pictures below to answer question 39.

39. The pictures shown below are arranged in a way that they tell a story. Use the pictures to help you write a story. The story should start with picture **1** and end with picture **4**. The story should be **one** page long.



Adapted from Masa a sele, Baratang Bokete, Phuthologo Kelaotswe, Malebogo Mokoloi, Medi Publishing, Gaborone, 2004.

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